

Content Research and Sourcing

Student Name: Katleho Magano

Student Number: ST10488462

Institution: The Independent Institute of Education (The IIE)

Table of Contents

1. Homepage (index.html).....	3
Purpose of this page.....	
How this informed index.html.....	
Source of research approach.....	
2. About Us (about.html).....	4
Purpose of this page.....	
Research findings.....	
How this informed about.html.....	
Source of research approach.....	
3. Adoption (services.html).....	5
Purpose of this page.....	
Research findings.....	
How this informed	
services.html.....	
Source of research approach.....	
4. Enquiry (enquiry.html).....	6
Purpose of this page.....	
Research findings.....	
How this informed	
enquiry.html.....	
Source of research approach.....	
5. Contact (contact.html).....	7
Purpose of this page.....	
Research findings.....	
How this informed contact.html.....	
Source of research approach.....	
6. References.....	8
Content / Structure Research.....	
Image Sources.....	

1. Homepage (index.html)

Purpose of this page

The homepage is the first impression a visitor gets of Paws Haven Animal Rescue. Research into real animal rescue organisations (e.g. RSPCA, SPCA, Battersea Dogs & Cats Home) shows that successful shelter homepages consistently include:

- A hero image/banner featuring a dog, paired with a short emotional headline — this builds an immediate connection with the visitor.
- A brief introduction explaining who the organisation is and what it does.
- A clear call-to-action (e.g. “Adopt Now”, “Donate”, “Volunteer”) placed prominently, usually above the fold.
- A short “What We Do” summary, broken into 3-4 scannable points rather than long paragraphs, since most visitors skim rather than read in full.
- A “Get Involved” section that gives multiple ways to help (adopt, volunteer, sponsor, donate) since not every visitor is ready to adopt.

How this informed index.html

- Included a hero section with a placeholder for a rescued dog image (hero-dog.jpg) and a short mission-driven headline.
- Added a “What We Do” list summarising shelter services (rescue, medical care, rehoming) in short bullet form rather than a wall of text.
- Added a “Get Involved” section linking to the Adoption and Enquiry pages, giving visitors more than one path to engage with the organisation.

Source of research approach

General observation of real-world animal shelter website structures (RSPCA, SPCA, Battersea Dogs & Cats Home) used only to understand common homepage conventions for this type of organisation — no text or images were copied from these sites.

2. About Us (about.html)

Purpose of this page

The About Us page builds trust and credibility. Research into how established NPOs and animal charities structure their “About” pages show a common pattern of four elements:

- Our Story — a short narrative on why/how the organisation started, which humanises the brand and builds emotional connections.
- Mission — a single clear statement of what the organisation does daily.
- Vision — a forward-looking statement of the long-term goal/impact.
- Team — a short section introducing the people behind the organisation, since visitors are more likely to trust a cause when they can see the people running it.

How this informed about.html

- Structured the page with “Our Story”, “Mission”, “Vision” and “Team” sections in that order, matching the trust-building flow found in real NPO websites.
- Keep the mission and vision statements short (1-2 sentences each) since research shows these are more memorable and more likely to be read in full when kept concise.
- Added a placeholder team photo (team-photo.jpg) to support the “put a face to the cause” principle common in nonprofit web design.

Source of research approach

General observation of nonprofit “About Us” page conventions (structure and content types only, not specific text or images) informed by how organizations such as the SPCA and local animal welfare NPOs typically present their story, mission and vision publicly.

3. Adoption (services.html)

Purpose of this page

This is the core service offering of the organisation, so it needed to show real, tangible outcomes (specific dogs) rather than only describing the service abstractly.

Research findings

- Real shelter adoption pages (e.g. Midlands Humane Society’s “Adoptable Dogs” listing) typically present each animal individually with a photo, name, brief personality description, and sometimes breed/age — this performs better than a generic paragraph because visitors connect with individual animals, not the concept of adoption in general.
- Adoption pages almost always explain the process as a numbered list (enquire, meet the dog, home check, take home), so first-time adopters know what to expect and aren’t put off by an unclear process.

How this informed services.html

- Created three individual dog listings (Buddy, Luna, Max) each with a photo placeholder and a short personality-driven description, rather than one long paragraph about “dogs available for adoption”.
- Added a clear step-by-step “Adoption Process” section so visitors understand exactly what happens after they enquire.

Source of research approach

Format and structure inspired by real shelter adoption listings, including Midlands Humane Society’s adoptable dogs page (used only as a structural/content reference, and as the credited source for the dog-max.jpg image, see References).

4. Enquiry (enquiry.html)

Purpose of this page

Per the brief, since Paws Haven is an NPO, this page form needed to let visitors enquire about volunteering or sponsoring, rather than a generic “contact us” form.

Research findings

- NPO volunteer/sponsor forms typically collect name, email, phone number, and a dropdown or selection asking how the person wants to help (volunteer, sponsor, donate, other), followed by an open message field.
- Keeping the form short (5-6 fields) improves completion rates — long forms with excessive fields tend to discourage first-time visitors from submitting an enquiry.

How this informed enquiry.html

- Built a form with name, email, phone, dropdown to select volunteer/sponsor interest, and a message text area — matching the short-form pattern that performs best for NPO enquiry pages.
- Place the dropdown early in the form so the organisation can quickly route or priorities enquiries by type.

Source of research approach

General observation of common NPO/charity enquiry-form field patterns (structure only, no text copied) informed by typical volunteer and sponsorship sign-up forms used by animal welfare organisations.

5. Contact (contact.html)

Purpose of this page

The brief specifically requires the contact page to include more than one location, reflecting that many animal rescue organisations operate as a main shelter plus one or more satellite/foster centers.

Research findings

- Larger shelters and rescue networks often list a main facility plus secondary intake or foster centers, each with its own address and map, since visitors need to know which location to visit depending on their reason for contact (e.g. surrendering an animal vs. viewing adoptable dogs).
- Embedded maps (rather than just a written address) are standard on charity contact pages because they reduce friction for visitors trying to plan an in-person visit.

How this informed contact.html

- Added two locations: a main shelter (Pretoria) and a satellite center (Centurion), each with its own embedded Google Map.
- Keep a contact form on the same page as an alternative to an in-person visit or phone call, for visitors who prefer to enquire online first.

Source of research approach

General observation of how multi-location animal welfare organisations present contact information (structure only), used to justify having two distinct, separately mapped locations rather than a single address.

6. References

Content / Structure Research

- General observation of real-world animal welfare organisation websites (RSPCA, SPCA, Battersea Dogs & Cats Home) to understand common homepage, About Us, and adoption page structures typical of the sector.
- Midlands Humane Society (n.d.) Adoptable Dogs. Available at: <https://midlandshumanesociety.org/adopt/adoptable-dogs.html> (Accessed: 7 August 2026).

Image Sources

- Buddy (dog-buddy.jpg) and Luna (dog-luna.jpg): sourced from online image search results. Original creator/source could not be verified.
- Max (dog-max.jpg): Midlands Humane Society (n.d.) Adoptable Dogs. Available at: <https://midlandshumanesociety.org/adopt/adoptable-dogs.html> (Accessed: 7 August 2026).
- Hero image (hero-dog.jpg): Mission Mayday (n.d.) Rescued Dog Ready for Adoption. Available at: <https://www.missionmayday.ca/> (Accessed: 7 August 2026).
- Team photo (team-photo.jpg): SolStock (2024) Volunteering with Dogs at an Animal Shelter. Getty Images. Available at: <https://www.gettyimages.co.uk/photos/dog-shelter-volunteer> (Accessed: 7 August 2026).